

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 20, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 12:1-22

1 Now these were the men who came to David at Ziklag while he was still a fugitive from Saul the son of Kish; and they were among the mighty men, helpers in the war,

2 armed with bows, using both the right hand and the left in hurling stones and shooting arrows with the bow. They were of Benjamin, Saul's brethren.

3 The chief was Ahiezer, then Joash, the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite; Jeziel and Pelet the sons of Azmaveth; Berachah, and Jehu the Anathothite;

4 Ishmaiah the Gibeonite, a mighty man among the thirty, and over the thirty; Jeremiah, Jahaziel, Johanan, and Jozabad the Gederathite;

5 Eluzai, Jerimoth, Bealiah, Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite;

6 Elkanah, Jisshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam, the Korahites;

7 and Joelah and Zebadiah the sons of Jeroham of Gedor.

8 Some Gadites joined David at the stronghold in the wilderness, mighty men of valor, men trained for battle, who could handle shield and spear, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as gazelles on the mountains:

9 Ezer the first, Obadiah the second, Eliab the third,

10 Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the fifth,

11 Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh,

12 Johanan the eighth, Elzabad the ninth,

13 Jeremiah the tenth, and Machbanai the eleventh.

14 These were from the sons of Gad, captains of the army; the least was over a hundred, and the greatest was over a thousand.

15 These are the ones who crossed the Jordan in the first month, when it had overflowed

all its banks; and they put to flight all those in the valleys, to the east and to the west.

16 Then some of the sons of Benjamin and Judah came to David at the stronghold.

17 And David went out to meet them, and answered and said to them, “If you have come peaceably to me to help me, my heart will be united with you; but if to betray me to my enemies, since there is no wrong in my hands, may the God of our fathers look and bring judgment.”

18 Then the Spirit came upon Amasai, chief of the captains, and he said: “We are yours, O David; We are on your side, O son of Jesse! Peace, peace to you, And peace to your helpers! For your God helps you.” So David received them, and made them captains of the troop.

19 And some from Manasseh defected to David when he was going with the Philistines to battle against Saul; but they did not help them, for the lords of the Philistines sent him away by agreement, saying, “He may defect to his master Saul and endanger our heads.”

20 When he went to Ziklag, those of Manasseh who defected to him were Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai, captains of the thousands who were from Manasseh.

21 And they helped David against the bands of raiders, for they were all mighty men of valor, and they were captains in the army.

22 For at that time they came to David day by day to help him, until it was a great army, like the army of God.

II. Key Summary

- While David was hiding at Ziklag out of fear of Saul, and later at the stronghold in the wilderness, fighting men kept coming over to him — including Benjamites from Saul's own tribe, men of Gad, and men of Manasseh.
- When men of Benjamin and Judah arrived at the stronghold, David first went out and asked whether they came peaceably to help him or to betray him; the Spirit came upon Amasai, who answered, "We are yours, O David... For your God helps you," and David received them and made them captains.
- The passage closes by recording that at that time men came to David day by day to

help him, until it was a great army, like the army of God.

III. Passage Analysis

The help people brought was signed by God

In Amasai's song the words "help" and "peace" appear again and again, answering the very "help" and "peace" David had asked about — proof that it was God who supplied all this "help" in the middle of David's weakness. [1]

David asked whether these men came to help him or to hand him over (v. 17), and Amasai's answer lifted the question one level higher: "For your God helps you" (v. 18). The same word "help" keeps returning in verses 1, 17, 18, 19, 21 and 22, pointing past the helpers to the One behind them.

Men with nowhere to go became an army like the army of God

Under the hand of God and His servant David, these mighty men — who began as disaffected people with nowhere else to go (1 Samuel 22:1-2) — developed into an amazing force. [2]

Verse 22 says they came "day by day to help him, until it was a great army" — this army was added up one day at a time. What they started with was not strength but having nowhere else to turn.

IV. Reflection Question

In the past month or two, who went out of their way to help you with one specific thing? Lending you something, walking with you, speaking up for you — all of it counts. Write down the person and what they did.

When David was at Ziklag and most afraid, people came to help him day by day, and the passage traces the source of that help back to God — "For your God helps you."

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, 1 Chronicles Comprehensive Commentary ("歷代志上第十二章拾穗"),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT12.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 12 – David's Army,"

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-12/>